standing by them at times of distress. In line with actions in other domains, here too, declarations have been backed by delivery. The PM has taken a particular interest in the establishment of online portals, welfare funds and response systems for such contingencies.

There is a lot that is personal about diplomacy, particularly at the leadership level. One of the visible achievements of PM Modi has been the ability to establish the right chemistry with his international peers. It could vary from Western leaders to Gulf rulers, from democratic politicians to those less cyclical, and from those proximate to India to others from a very different ethos. There is no set formula, but one can see that many relationships emerged from exchange of experiences and respect for achievements. Like any competitive domain, those who are doing well, be it in popularity rating, source of ideas or governance delivery, tend to naturally attract the interest and admiration of others. But it could also be something more personal or cultural. For example, PM Modi's discipline of fasting was a major talking point during his 2014 visit to the US, and even afterwards. It elicited a lot of curiosity about the underlying outlook as well. Similarly, his propagation of yoga and his own practice of it was often a subject of conversation with fellow leaders. And this extended from food habits and traditional medicine to culture, heritage and history, to the extent that as these encounters left their impressions, India too ended up occupying greater mind-space.

Then, there was the influence of ideas and thoughts that PM Modi often articulated on contemporary issues. The United Nations (UN) Climate Change Conference (COP21) in Paris in 2015 was such an occasion, where he surprised many with his fervent advocacy of solar energy. In fact, some Western leaders came to meet him expecting that they would have to argue for climate action. They ended up finding India a few steps ahead of their own beliefs. It is interesting that many of the big thoughts of the last decade in this domain have come personally from PM Modi, including at the Glasgow COP26 in 2021.

Another aspect of relevance is how much Modi's focus on technology has contributed to forging connections across the world. Initially, it began with global interest in how his 2014 campaign was shaped by its application. But soon enough, it extended to governance practices and policy drivers. The manner in which digital delivery worked for social welfare or Covid management was certainly noted internationally.